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Ridgeville Elementary School's Extremely Talinted Show
By Matthew Yasuoka

Performance Notes

The first part is approximately ten minutes long and can be performed in its entirety with minor adjustments. It is followed by an alternate ending and additional scenes all of which can be added anywhere into the first part. I like some of the alternate material better than the main stuff. But that's just me. The main stuff was simply the first ten minutes I wrote; everything else was written after. There are a ton of characters and some of the blocking is extremely physical e.g. the montage. There are also a ton of characters. Lines that can be switched to another character are indicated in the text. There are some stage directions, but not a ton. There is a section called Horner-isms these are meant to be one liners sprinkled throughout should the performer desire to use them.

Dramatis Personas

Principal Horner - Male, 40s, slick
Marcus - five or six small for his age
Tina - Eight to twelve nerdy, know it all
Angela- Nine to twelve kind of lost
John- Seven to twelve large and chubby
Clyde- Eleven, Flamboyant
Clyde's dad- Late Thirties, white
Jacob- Twelve, creepy, raspy, cigarette voice
Nixon- Puppet Jacob's hand puppet (Note: can have the same voice as Jacob)
Carl- Eleven Geeky but still kind of handsome in a Bill Gatesy way
Kenny- Plays the saxophone*
Joseph- Juggles while wearing a Technicolor dream coat before being thrown down the well.*
Billy- Eleven dancer*
Issac- Mime*
Stephen- Break dancer*
Steven- Thirteen and in sixth grade really nervous, really, really nervous+
Taylor- Six tames gerbils+
Artist- Eleven is a diva+

*indicates that character has no speaking liners
+indicates they are in additional material

Main Piece

Principle Horner: Good evening, parents, friends, and the people we paid to make sure the audience wasn't empty, and welcome to our talent show. I'll be the first to acknowledge that our kids aren't that talented.

Marcus: I resent that.

Principal Horner: Especially that one. Tonight they will put on a mediocre to terrible show with a few moments that are astonishingly average.

Tina: I'm of above average intellect.

Principal Horner: Yes of course you are Tina... I mean look at the signs she puts the "I" in talented literally.

Tina: But…

[flash back]

Principal Horner: You're spelling it wrong!

Tina: But "talented" is spelt with an "e"

Principal Horner: That's "talented" we want to say "talinted" with an "I"

[flash back done]

Angela: I don't get it... Isn't there an "I" in talented

Principal Horner: Of course you don't! So let's just pull this Band-Aid and get this over with! Our first... untalented individual... oh and this should be good... is Marcus Greenbrooke...

Marcus: Hey! I is talented

Principal Horner: No you're not. Believe me I've seen people on Broadway, in Vegas, and in Hollywood more talented than you!

Tina: But that's an unfair representative sample. That represents the top percentage of America, and so everyone isn't talented...

Horner: So you agree with me.

Tina: No... no... no in comparison to them no one is talented.

Horner: So you agree.

Tina: No, I don't; you're falling victim to confirmation bias citing statistics that confirm your preconceived notions.

Horner: Blah blah blah do you have a degree?

Tina: No

Horner: Well I have one and therefore you should shut up!

Tina: Appeal to authority fallacy!

Horner: Why are you even here? What's your talent never getting a date in your life?

[Flashback]

Guy 1: Sorry

Guy 2: No way

Guy 3: Later

[End Flashback]

Carl: That's not very nice

Horner: Whatever—Carl. Here's Marcus doing something not talented.

Marcus: Hey!

Horner: Just get out there in front of the people...

Marcus: La la la la la... wait a minute people? You... you... you... you... dididididiididiididididiiddint tell me there would be p-p-p-p-p-p-
people!

Horner: Are you going to perform?

Marcus: mwranackanananananann people [hyperventilating] there [breathing] are... people!!!!! So... many... people..... [dying rhinoceros]... people... so many people!!!

Horner: Give a horrified stare of astonishment for Marcus and his... stage fright!

Marcus: So many, so many, so many [ad nauseum]

Horner: Thank you Marcus. Up next is 2nd grader Clyde Johnson.

Clyde's dad: Yeah das my boi. Uhhhyeahhhhh

Clyde: Father please stop your provincial behavior.

Clyde's dad:	Whatevs home slice. I'm keeping it real; you know what I'm saying.
Clyde:	Stop it! Your kibitzing is a vulgar bastardization of this event.
Clyde's dad:	Bastardization?! I know who my mama is! Your G-ma will be hurt!
Horner:	Performing "Girls Just Want To have Fun"
Clyde's dad:	What?! You told me you was doin' "Ice Ice Baby"… or at the very least "Under Pressure"
Clyde:	That's your dream dad not mine! Wait so you admit Vanilla Ice stole the beat?
Clyde's dad:	Correction, Queen stole it.
Clyde:	You're a monster
Horner:	Tik-tik-tik-tik-tik-tik-tok
Clyde's dad:	You're not doing the show!
Clyde:	Oh daddy dear
Horner:	While I love watching *Intervention: Live*… the show must go on… this show, not that one.
Clyde:	You're still number one
Clyde's dad:	Get in the car
Clyde:	But girls they wanna have fun
Clyde's dad:	Well that's nice, but you're a boy
Clyde:	Girls just want to have fun thats all they really wantttttttttt
Horner:	Our next performer is... umm... hold on... [sounds out] john smith ... why did you have to have such a difficult name? huh huh
John:	Sorry
Horner:	That's right you better be. And his talent is playing with his fat.
John:	Look what I can do. [swings his belly in circles]
Horner:	Eww gross
John:	[continues swinging]
Marcus:	um... um... I'-I-I-I'm scared
John:	[laughs]
Horner:	I'm speechless
John:	Yay!!! I'd like to thank McDonalds, Burger King, and my Mom and Dad... they're the fourth and fifth row.
Tina:	Don't ridicule him, according to the WHO 1.5 billion adults are overweight.
Horner:	[turns around to face Tina] Thank you Dr. Phil.
Tina:	He's a family therapist not a medical doctor.
Horner:	I said, "thank you Tina."
Tina:	No, you said, "thank you Dr. Phil."
Horner:	No, I said, "thank you Tina."
Tina:	The correct pop culture allusion would have been: thank you Dr. Oz.
Horner:	I said, "thank you!!!!"
Tina:	But...
Horner:	No "but"s we don't need your interjections. [turns around] Parent's did you know that the GQR said that
Tina:	It's the WHO
Horner:	Whatever... 1.5 billion people are obese. Look John there are people like you! 1.5 billion and we wonder why earth is overcrowded. Give it up for John... and America folks! Whose next... Jacob and his marionette
Jacob:	Howdy. This is Mr. Nixon. [Holds up puppet]
Nixon:	The name's Richard but you can call me Dick...
Horner:	You can say that again.
Nixon:	The name's Richard, but...
Marcus:	Dick? Dick?
Nixon:	Yes?
Marcus:	Why are Jacob's lips moving?
Nixon:	No they aren't.
Marcus:	Yes they are Dick.
Jacob:	My lips aren't moving.

Marcus: They just moved.
Horner: He's got a point they did move.
Nixon: That's because Jacob was talking.
Horner: Don't defend him Dick! He's a democrat.
Nixon: So am I!
Tina: Nixon wasn't a Democrat! Take that back!
Jacob: Yes, I was
Marcus: Your lips just moved.
Nixon: No they didn't!
Marcus: Dick Nixon is a liar!
Tina: You can say that again!
Nixon: Listen up Robert Frost
Tina: Wrong Frost, you're thinking of David Frost the journalist, not the poet.
Nixon: I quit!
Tina: Quitting and lying some things never change!
Marcus: Jacob's lips moved!
Nixon: No they didn't
Marcus: Liar! Liar!
Tina: And you sound nothing like Nixon!
Nixon: Shut up Hillary Clinton! You Margaret Thatcher! You Mother Theresa!
Horner: All right thank you Jacob. A fine product of the public school history curriculum if I do say so myself! Really affirms what we're doing here!
Tina: But, the rampant factual inaccuracies!
Horner: They don't know about them! Shut up! [quietly] In the same vein of history based talent is Carl Carlson performing his Anthony Weiner impersonation.
Carl: Hey kids. Are you ready? Cause I am! To get my Tweet on [begins taking off his shirt]
Tina: Whistle
Horner: What?
John: [whistles]
Marcus: I am uncomfortable!
Carl: [Takes out phone] This ones for you Tina!
Tina: [Faints]
Horner: Ummmm
Carl: And now the finally [starts to take off pants]
Marcus: Un-com-for-ta-ble
John: [breathing hard]
Horner: Okay woah woah woah! We may be in a left leaning state but this is a G-rated show. And you're gonna have to stop.
Tina: What are you now, China?
John: Boo censorship.
Horner: As a responsible administrator I have to put a stop to these shenanigans.
Carl: I've been censored like Google in china
Tina: That's the hottest thing I've ever heard!
Carl: You're as hot as the planet will be in 2050!
Tina: Oh baby!
Carl: What do you say we go election scandal on them?
Tina: Oh yes!
Horner: The only appropriate election scandal in these parts is Watergate!
Carl: I say we impeach him
John: I like peaches!
Tina: Not peaches you lummox
John: Yum lox I love that too.
Carl: Your vocabulary is
Horner: Everyone shut up!

Montage sequence
[NOTE: performers can substitute any talents they choose these are just suggestions]

[SFX: Don't Stop Believing/ Eye of the tiger / Born this Way]
Horner: Give it up for...
Horner: Kenny
[Plays saxophone]
Horner: Joseph
[Kid juggling]
Horner: Billy!
[Kid tap dancing]
Horner: Issac
[Mimes / music pauses]
Horner: Stephen
[Break dancing]
Horner: Angela
[Does splits]
Angela: Ta-da
Horner: Thank you! Thank you! Thank you! Well that concludes our performances this evening and there's only one thing left to do!
Clyde's dad: Woah-woah-woah D-homie G hold-up.
Horner: Oh you've got to be kidding me! I want to go home!
Clyde's dad: My brother you got to let my boi perform
Horner: You're son forfeited the competition by missing his allotted time.
Clyde's dad: Please man you gotta let my kid do his thang... I was bein' pretty stupid befor'. you gotta man. You can't blame a kid for his pa's mistakes
Horner: Sure I can! In fact I'm doing it right now. Go skedaddle.
Clyde's dad: Come on man!
Horner: Look dude... I said no.
Clyde's dad: Okay my brother. [reaches into coat] have it your way.
Horner: Oh god don't shoot me! Please, please, please.
Clyde's dad: Shoot you? What the hell? No I was just gonna forward these pics [show on phone] from your twitter to the press
Horner: I wish you'd shot me! But.... he can perform!
Clyde: [SFX: Girls they want to have fun sings and dances]
Horner: Are you done?
Clyde: Yupsies
Horner: Well then there's only one thing to do crown the winner... drum roll please! [[1]]Because you all lack any talent the winner is... me! That's right! Suck it, all of you, I win!
Marcus: B-b-b-b-but you didn't even perform.
Horner: Marcus...
Marcus: Yes
Horner: Whose the principal?
Marcus: You...
Horner: So I said I win. Therefore, I win.
Carl: Wait you just admitted to being as corrupt as an Afghan election.
Tina: As invalid as an election in Florida.
Carl: I love you.
Tina: Agape, Philia, Storge...
Carl: Eros.
Tina: ...
John: ...
Horner: Well that awkwardly concludes our talent show and that's "talint" with an I. Please don't file any lawsuits. And have a nice evening. [[2]]

[1] Alternate ending would begin here and replace text up to

Backstage

Carl:	Tina
Tina:	Yes Carl?
Carl:	Will you go to the library with me?
Clyde:	Dad?
Clyde's dad:	Yes little homie?
Clyde:	I didn't win...
Clyde's dad:	Yes you did you won me over. you be who you is okay?
Clyde:	Okay.

Alternate ending

Horner:	And the winner is Richard Nixon!!!!
Marcus:	What?
Tina:	What?
Jacob:	Yeah!
Nixon:	Shut up fool! I won not you!
Marcus:	His lips moved!
Tina:	I smell a Watergate part 2
Carl:	Talentgate
Tina:	That's the hottest thing I've heard since Spock said, "logic clearly dictates that the needs of the many outweigh the needs of the few."
Carl:	I love you.
Tina:	Agape, Philia, Storge...
Carl:	Eros.
Tina:	But… Aphrodite can wait!
Carl:	She can?!
Tina:	There's corruption to bust...
Carl:	There's only one bust I'm thinking about… Tina...
Tina:	Yes?
Carl:	Will you...
John:	Yes.....
Carl:	Go...
John:	Yes....
Carl:	And
John:	Yes...
Tina:	Will you shut up?
John:	Fine.
Carl:	Pursue a pulitzer with me?
Tina:	Carl...
Carl:	Yes
Tina:	I'd love to!
Carl:	To the library!
Horner:	Well wasn't that exciting. I'm Principal Horner, and this concludes our program. Jeez young love, a Nixon scandal, it's like the eighties or something! And just for the record the real winner of tonight's talent show is me,
Tina:	"I"
Horner:	No, it's not you—you didn't even perform—it's me, me.
Tina:	That's grammatically incorrect, it's "I"
Horner:	I thought you left.
Tina:	I did…
Horner:	Then how did you get back here?
Tina:	A hole in the space time continuum
Horner:	Okay then! I win, because I'm the only one with any talent...
Marcus:	But you didn't perform.

[2] here

Horner: Marcus, go to hell. Goodnight, have a safe ride home, and parents remember you signed a liability waiver, that renders us—by us I mean me—unaccountable for mental, physical, and psychological harm. So don't you dare call your lawyers. All of this is between us.

Other Talents

"Imaginary Friend"

Horner: Please welcome Steven and...
Steven: Willie Simple.
Marcus: There's no one there...
Steven: Yes there is...
John: No there isn't
Steven: Yes there is and you'll see you'll all see
Angela: Is this why we call him crazy steven? [NOTE: Marcus or John can also say this line]
Steven: You guys call me Crazy Steven.
Angela: Oh puh-leeze don't play dumb you totally knew. I mean Jill said that to your face like [counts on fingers] what's less than two.
Marcus: Oo-oo-oo-oo-oo I know!
Angela: Okay that's great but I don't
Marcus: One
Angela: No that's not it. What's the one before that?
Marcus: Oo-oo-oo-oo-oo I know!
Angela: Okay, okay you don't have to brag… now tell me.
Marcus: Zero.
Angela: Yeah Jill totally said it to you like 0 times last week
John: Wait that means she never said it to him
Angela: Yeah. Duh. But she thought like [counts] this many times.
Tina: Two times?
Angela: No more than that but less than like infinity!
Steven: I'm going to prove you all wrong all of you! You'll see it's Willie Simple and he's my best friend.
Marcus: There's no one there.
Steven: Yes, there is.
Marcus: No, there isn't!
Steven: Tell them a joke; go on. [starts laughing] Wasn't that a good one guys?
Angela: Sometimes, I hear voices too and they tell me to take off all my clothes, but then I remember I have my headphones on, and it's getting hot in here…
Steven: Why can't you see him!?
Horner: Thank you.
Steven: I'm not crazy.
Horner: Get off the stage
Steven: I'm not.
Horner: Security.
Steven: No, I'm not. Do I look crazy to you? Do I?
Angela: Yes.
Horner: Well… That was interesting.

"Gerbil Taming"

Horner: Because we let anyone be a part of this show no matter what they want to do here's Taylor, who will tantalize you with Gerbil Taming.
Angela: I had a gerbil once…
Horner: Thank you Angela.
Angela: His name was Princess Glitter
Tina: Princess' are girls.

Angela: And so was he.
Tina: That makes no sense.
Angela: I'm telling the story captain obvious.
Taylor: They're really dangerous because they have big teeth and stuff. But they like smoothies
Angela: His favorite food was smoothies.
Taylor: I have one right here.
Angela: And one day I was feeding a smoothie out of the blender just like he liked it.
Taylor: And watch as he takes a lick of the fruity drink!
Angela: Only I forgot the blender was on. Then he became a smoothie. It's kinda juxtaposition.
Tina: You mean ironic.
Angela: Whatever, English is my second language.
Tina: What's your first?
Angela: Unicorn.
Taylor: And then he falls asleep. And then I love him and cuddle him.
Gerbil: [bites]
Taylor: [starts crying] I just wanna love you!!!!!!!!
Horner: Thank you Taylor wasn't that precious… oops sorry I misspoke that wasn't precious.

"Reading"

Horner: Seriously? This is a talent! You've got to be kidding me? Whatever here's Constance… reading.
Constance: [Sits down opens book]
Horner: Silently.
Constance: [Continues reading]
Marcus: Can you at least read me story?
Angela: Reading is really hard. Reading and talking that's impossible like cats dying only one time.
Constance: [Turns page]
John: My cat only died once… last week.
Angela: Last time I checked Wikipedia they had nine lives. Like Mario.
John: Mario only starts with three lives!
Horner: Thank you Constance. For that spell binding performance. Get it books have bindings spell binding. I'm a genius. Hold your applause. You're such an obedient bunch.

"Random Musical Number"

Horner: Well this should be great… hey what happened to the lights… and why is there? Music? Oh god it's a random musical number! Performed by the artist formerly known as Lady Dada but changed her name for copyright-reasons-who-was-formerly-known-as-Princess-Bublegum-and-before-that-went-by-Mary-which-was-far-too-plain.
[Tune of "Party in the USA"]
Artist: I got off the bus at station six
With my mom and my dad and pants
Tina: Wait a minute that doesn't make sense
Artist: Why you gotta be so tense
Marcus: Sittin' in a chair and I'm seein' on the people
More shocked than a lightinin' struck steeple
John: It was all so tasty
Really wish I had a pastry
Artist: The crowd is all over my total hotness
So damn sexy that you love me
Tina: We never rehearsed this whole singing bit?
And why doesn't it rhyme
It still doesn't rhyme
I wish that it rhymed
Artist: So I just nod my head and sing some lines
Tina: Logic flies away

Artist: Pumpin' my fist like yeah
Tina: That's not an adjective
Artist: So I just nod my head and sing some lines
Tina: Logic flies away
Artist/Tina: Yeahahahahaha it's America today
Yeahahahahaha it's America today
Horner: Yeahahaha back to the show okay?
Yeahahaha next act while it's today

Angela: Hey that totally similied
Tina: You mean rhymed
Angela: Totally. Whatevs.
Horner: Why the hell was I singing?

"That's Random"

Clark: Look what I can do [do black flip]
Horner: Who are you? Did you even sign up?

"The Mass x Acceleration is strong"

Horner: Up next is John... didn't you already go...
John: Yup
Horner: Well... I suppose you count for two people... using the force.
Tina: Which is mass times acceleration
Horner: He's certainly got a lot of the former.
John: Prepare to have your mind... blown... ba boom.
Horner: How profound... profoundly boring that is.
John: [focuses really hard] hmmmmmmmmmmmmmmmmmm
Horner: Okay then don't burst a blood vessel... I don't want to call the ambulance... correction I won't call the ambulance.
Marcus: Is is is something supposed to be happening?
John: [begins shaking]
Horner: The mass is defnitely accelerating
John: [shake harder]
Marcus: Is that your milkshake?
John: Why? Why won't you work? I believe! I believe!
Horner: Wow that was worse than *Star Wars Episode Two*, give it up with your collective moans

Horner-isms

Horner: This pretty much disproves Paula Dean's claim that, "everythings better with butter!"
Horner: Imma let you finish, but *America's Got Talent* is the best talent show ever.
Horner: Bad singing, bad dancing, bad attire why it's like the seventies all over again.
Horner: Oposed.
Horner: Wow, you just made Tom Cruise on Oprah's couch look respectable.
Horner: That deserves a fist pump.
Horner: It felt like the end of the world came early there... or at least I wish it had.
Horner: That was almost as painless as Troll 2.
Horner: I once auditioned for *America Idol*, and then they gave the job to Ryan Secrest... Ryan... Secrest.
Horner: Here's Angela talking... believe me this girl never stops... it's like NPR. And unlike NPR you can't cut this station.
Tina: NPR's possible funding cut is not something to joke about!
Horner: Boo hoo hoo I just did!
Horner: what did the lizard say to the other when he fell off the walll
click click click [laugh] what you don't get it? At least it's better than anything these kids are doing!